

Activity 4: Snowball

Aims

To encourage learners to look up and record new vocabulary, to review vocabulary from the Reading / Reading and Use of English paper.

Level

Adaptable from A2 to C2.

Step 1

Give each learner a strip of paper with a challenging word, idiom or collocation taken from the Reading / Reading and Use of English paper.

If your learners have access to dictionaries, give them time to do their own research to find a definition, part of speech, pronunciation and example sentence for their word. The [Cambridge Learner Dictionary](#) is available free online. Ask learners to write a definition or an example sentence with their word on their strip of paper.

Monitor and support learners to help them find the meaning of the word and record information accurately from the dictionary. Point out useful features in the dictionary to help them, e.g. listen to the pronunciation.

Step 2

Ask learners to write a definition of their word or phrase, or they can write an example sentence and replace their word with a 'bleep' on the strip of paper, e.g. I use my 'bleep' to text my friends.
[mobile phone]

Step 3

Learners mingle and share their definition/example sentence with another learner.

- Can their partner guess the word or phrase?
- If their partner can't guess, the learner teaches it to them.
- When partners have both guessed their words/phrases, they exchange their strips of paper.

Step 4

Learners find a new partner and repeat Step 3 with their new word or phrase.

Exchanging words and phrases in this way builds in repetition and helps learners expand and learn a wider range of words.



Activity 4: Snowball

Step 5

As feedback, collect all of the papers from the learners. Go through the definitions and ask the class to shout out the words. This is a nice way to round off the activity as learners can usually remember the majority of words and it shows them how much new vocabulary they learned from the test.

Display the list of words on the board for learners to record in their notebooks.